

Bid / No-Bid Decision

This guide helps you decide if a federal opportunity is worth your time and money before you start writing a proposal.

What it is. Proposals cost a lot. You can burn cash fast by bidding on every opportunity that comes up. This process gives you a quick, structured way to evaluate a new federal contract and decide if you should pursue it or walk away. It puts your go/no-go decision on paper.

When to use it. Use this as soon as you find an opportunity you're considering, usually within 24-48 hours of it hitting [SAM.gov](https://sam.gov) or being shared by a partner. It's especially important for bids over \$1 million, where proposal costs can easily hit five figures. Don't wait until the RFP drops.

How to use it.

- First, open the "Bid / No-Bid Decision Matrix" and score the opportunity in five minutes. If it passes, move on.
- Next, use the "PWin Calculator" to assess your chances. Consider factors like customer fit, your past performance, and your likely price. Review the "PWin Worked Example" for a realistic score.
- Then, use the "Competitive Bid Analysis" to map out the incumbent and other likely bidders.
- Finally, complete the one-page "Bid Decision Memo (Word)" to document your go/no-go decision for your records.

Watch out for. Don't let "fear of missing out" push you to bid on something that doesn't fit your company or where your chances are low. Stick to the numbers.

Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/bid-no-bid> Next step: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/co-outreach> (Contracting Officer Outreach)